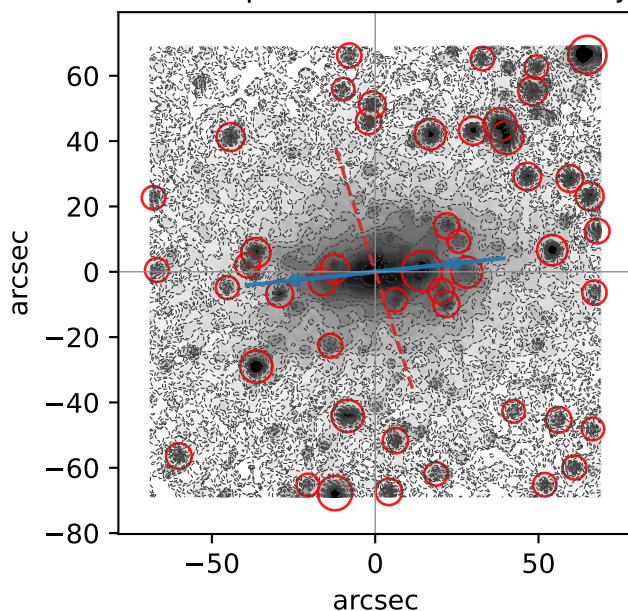
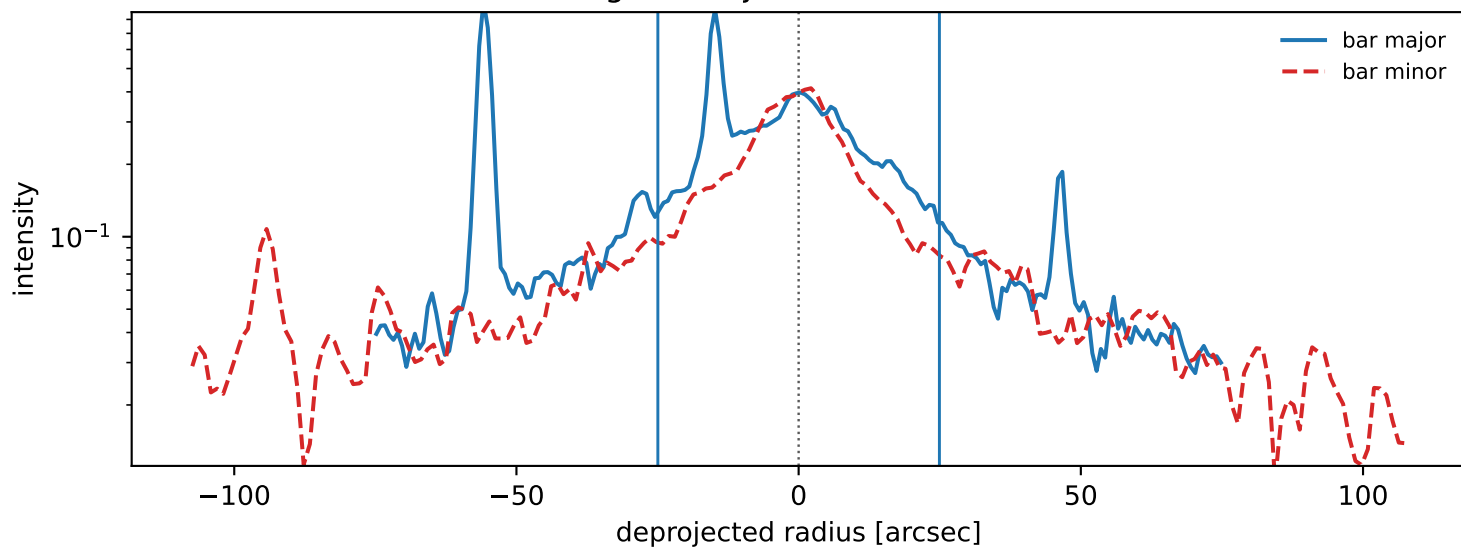


ESO120-012 foreground-mask profile comparison bar PA=96.0 deg

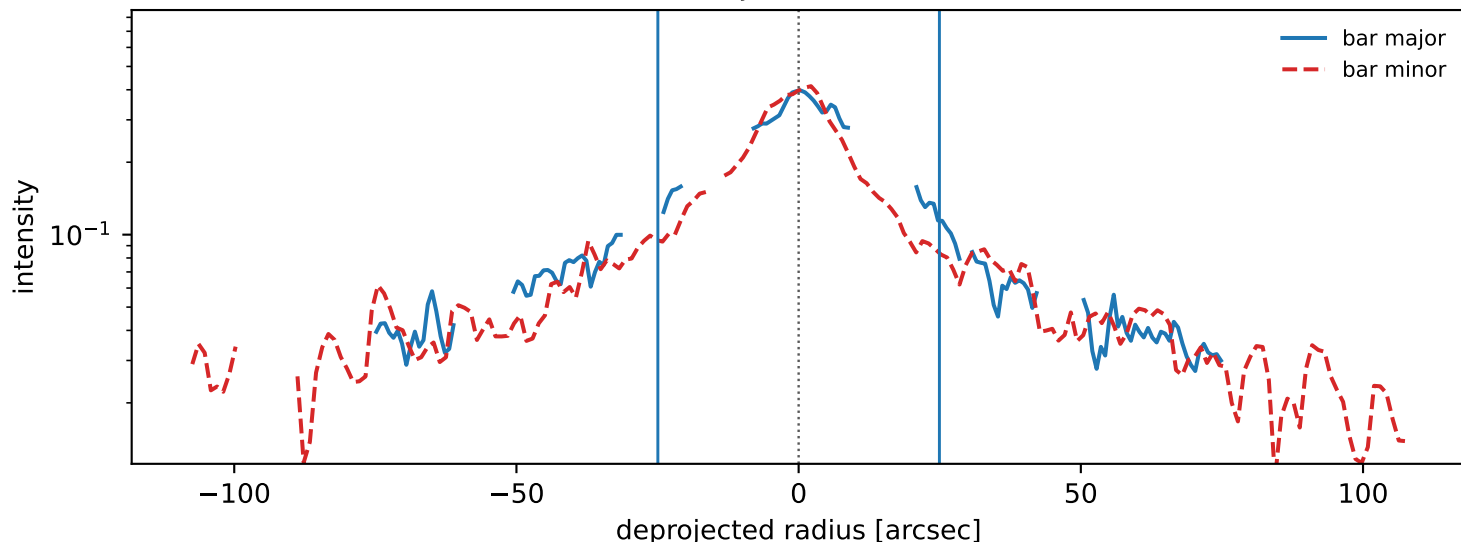
S4G 3.6 micron isophotes with masked objects circled



Original major/minor-axis cuts



Masked major/minor-axis cuts



Masking model: photutils segmentation on residual image (image - Gaussian-smoothed galaxy model; photutils 3.0.0). Parameters: smooth sigma=15 px; detection threshold=3.5 sigma above residual median; minimum connected pixels=8; dilation radius=3 px; max segment area=500 px; max elongation=6; central exclusion radius=12 px; profile width=3 px. Applied mask: 615 source segments, 52889 pixels ignored.